



GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

‘DESPAIR IS NOT AN OPTION’

Sen. Bernie Sanders (I-Vt.) speaks to an estimated 36,000 people during a “Fighting Oligarchy” rally on Saturday at Grand Park in downtown L.A. He also made a surprise appearance later at the Coachella Valley Music and Arts Festival. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

None of PUC members are from Southland

Panel has final say over utility rate hikes for SoCal, but all five appointed by Newsom live up north.

By MELODY PETERSEN

The five members of the California Public Utilities Commission make hundreds of decisions each year that affect Southern Californians, including determining how much most pay for electricity and natural gas and deciding whether phone companies need to offer landlines.

In the months ahead, the commission will consider raising electricity rates in the wake of the devastating Eaton fire. Videos captured the inferno igniting Jan. 7 under one of Southern California Edison’s transmission towers in Eaton Canyon. Edison has asked for an increase of more than 2%, which it said was needed to bolster Wall Street’s view of its financial health after the Los Angeles wildfires.

Yet none of the five commissioners lives in Southern California, where Edison and San Diego Gas & Electric alone serve almost 19 million people — nearly half the state’s population.

All five were appointed by Gov. Gavin Newsom and live in or near Sacramento or San Francisco, where the commission is based.

None of the five commissioners responded to emails from The Times asking whether they saw the lack of Southern California representation as an issue.

Before their appointments, two of the commissioners were senior advisors to Newsom on energy issues. A third was chief counsel at the state’s Energy Commission. The other two also previously had top jobs in the state government.

Newsom spokesman Daniel Villasenor defended [See PUC, A8]

Vietnam, once a beneficiary of tariffs, is now facing peril

Manufacturing hub is at risk of losing edge in exports to U.S.

By STEPHANIE YANG

QUANG NINH, Vietnam — When Le Ngoc Tham became sales manager for a new industrial park in northern Vietnam, the goal was to turn it into an easy alternative for manufacturers leaving China to avoid the tariffs of the first U.S.-Sino trade war.

Three years later, with less than half of the 1,716-acre project completed, dozens of companies interested in leasing the land are having second thoughts. The source of hesitation is President Trump’s latest tariffs, which, as announced this month, included a 46% tax on imports from Vietnam, the country’s eighth-largest trading partner.

But even though Trump announced a 90-day temporary stay on the new duties on Wednesday, and the administration said late Friday that it would exclude certain [See Vietnam, A4]



NHAC NGUYEN AFP/Getty Images

HIGH-TECH manufacturing in Quang Ninh province, above, contributed to Vietnam’s industrial development and strong economic growth.



Colossal Biosciences

THIS PHOTO from a Texas firm shows a genetically engineered wolf that’s similar to the extinct dire wolf.

Experts sniff at claim of ‘de-extincted’ dire wolf

By KAITLYN HUAMANI

When news broke that scientists in Texas had successfully reintroduced the long-extinct dire wolf to the modern world, more people than just “Game of Thrones” fans took notice.

Researchers at the Natural History Museum’s La

Brea Tar Pits, where a wall is decorated with hundreds of dire wolf skulls, had questions.

Namely, are they really dire wolves? Turns out, it depends on how you define it.

“What they have created is basically a genetically engineered gray wolf that has been given genetic traits so [See Wolf, A12]

Governor forced to flee from fire

Arson suspect is held after Pennsylvania Gov. Josh Shapiro and his family evacuate mansion. **NATION, A5**

Tech workers, leaders diverge

Silicon Valley rank and file oppose Trump as top executives in the industry shift to the right. **NATION, A9**

Another whale washes ashore

The cause of death of the young adult female with no signs of injury is a mystery, officials say. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather
Clearing.
L.A. Basin: 69/54. **B6**

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Sharing of IRS data worries immigrants

Taxpayers who lack legal status express anger and economic concern over handing of information to ICE.

By KEVIN RECTOR

One after another in recent weeks, Maria’s accounting clients raised the same fear: immigration agents finding and detaining them using information from their tax filings.

“I heard it from everybody,” said the 40-year-old consultant for undocumented small-business entrepreneurs in Southern California. “They come to me and they say, ‘Hey, should I do my taxes this year? Because they’re going to come find me.’”

Maria, who asked to be

State’s forests opened up for logging

Trump’s order to grow timber production will harm ecosystems across the country, environmentalists say.

By HAYLEY SMITH

California’s national forests are on the chopping block — literally — in the wake of the Trump administration’s April 5 order to immediately expand timber production in the United States.

Earlier this month, U.S. Secretary of Agriculture Brooke Rollins issued an emergency declaration that ordered the U.S. Forest Service to open up some 112.5 million acres of national forestland to logging.

The announcement included a grainy map of affected forests, which did not specify forest names or the amount of impacted acreage in each. However, U.S. Department of Agriculture officials have confirmed to The Times that the order will touch all 18 of the Golden State’s national forests, which collectively span more than 20 million acres.

“The USDA Forest Service stands ready to fulfill the Secretary’s vision of productive and resilient national forests outlined in the memorandum,” the agency said in a statement. “In alignment with the Secretary’s direction, we will streamline forest management efforts, reduce burdensome regulations, and grow partnerships to support economic growth and sustainability.”

California is home to more federal forests than any other state, including Angeles, Sequoia and Klamath national forests. Officials with the USDA, which oversees the Forest Service, said they do not yet have information about how many acres in each forest will be affected.

The directive stems from President Trump’s recent executive order to expand [See Timber, A12]

identified only by her first name for fear of being targeted by the Trump administration, said she understood well.

Maria has been in the U.S. for decades, has earned multiple degrees at California universities, has U.S. citizen children and has been applying for legal residency for years. But like many of her clients, she said, she lacks legal status.

Also like many of her clients, she has routinely paid U.S. taxes in the past using what’s known as an individual taxpayer identification number, or ITIN, in lieu of a Social Security number. The process seemed pretty straightforward, she said, until recently, when Trump administration officials announced that Internal Revenue Service data would be shared with Immigration and Customs Enforcement [See Data sharing, A9]



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